

Eggs

Like many of the dinosaurs themselves, eggs were often enormous. They were covered in hard shells like a chicken's egg, but were shaped differently. Although large, eggs were often much smaller than adult dinosaurs, so babies must have grown fast.

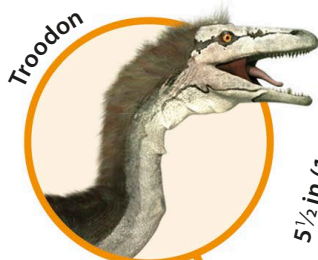


Citipati

7 in (18 cm) long

Citipati egg

Fossil finds show that beaked Citipati laid at least 20 oval eggs in a nest. These eggs were as big as a human hand. Recent research has shown that Citipati eggs were a blue-green color.



Troodon

5½ in (14 cm) long

Troodon egg

Many fossilized Troodon eggs have been found. This meat-eating dinosaur may have laid as many as 24 eggs in a single nest, which were partly covered with plants to help keep them warm.



Hen

2 in (5 cm) long

Chicken egg

Female chickens, or hens, lay small, hard-shelled eggs. They keep the eggs warm for about 21 days until the chick hatches.